KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 3: BUILDING THINGS · WEEK 11 · READING

The Night the Calf Came Early: Punctuating Dialogue

Name: _____ Date: _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Pre-Lesson Warm-Up: Talking on the Page

Before the lesson, show what you already know about writing what characters say. Do your best. It is fine to guess!

1. Add quotation marks around Grandpa's exact words: Grandpa said, The barn is warm.

2. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

   "Grab your boots," Grandpa said. | "Grab your boots". Grandpa said. | Grab your boots, "Grandpa said."

3. Rewrite with the correct capital letters: nadia said, "the snow is deep."

4. Add the missing comma: "Let's feed the calves" Nadia said.

5. Review: At the start of a story a girl says, "I can't do this." At the end she says, "I did it!" What does this show?

   Character change | Text structure | The author's purpose is to inform

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POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Post-Lesson Challenge: Dialogue Editor

Now use every dialogue rule you practiced today. Check quotation marks, commas, capitals, end marks and paragraphs.

1. Rewrite with correct punctuation and capitals: grandpa asked is clover okay

2. Find and fix the TWO mistakes: "we did it", Nadia shouted.

3. This conversation is written as one paragraph. Rewrite it correctly as two paragraphs: "Is the calf warm?" Nadia asked. "Warm as toast," Grandpa said.

4. Nadia is trying not to wake the sleeping calf. Which tag fits best?

   shouted whispered hollered called

5. Writing: Write 4 lines of dialogue between Nadia and Grandpa the next morning when they visit Blizzard. Use a tag BEFORE a quote at least once and AFTER a quote at least once, start a new paragraph for each speaker, and let the dialogue show how one character feels.

★ **Challenge:** Write a short scene (6 to 8 lines) set on a farm, in a city, or in a village where two characters disagree about something. Use dialogue to show each character's viewpoint, start a new paragraph for each speaker, and use only ONE strong tag (like muttered or called) in the whole scene.

Looking Ahead: Week 12: Informative writing. You will build strong paragraphs with topic sentences, supporting details and transition words while touring an apartment building going up in Houston.